

LAB 2 – AGILE BACKLOG CREATION & SPRINT SIMULATION

Jira Project Report

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Section: I

1. Introduction

The management of the Virtual Technical Conference Platform with Agile methodology has been done with the help of Jira in this lab. The functional requirements generated in the previous lab have been changed into epics and user stories. Story points have been allocated, and two sprints have been planned in the backlog of Jira.

2. Objective

The first objective is to develop a backlog of an agile process in Jira, estimate the amount of work done in story points, conduct two sprints, and analyze burndown charts.

3. Project Overview

The current project is titled as a Virtual Technical Conference Platform. The features included in the backlog are as follows: submission of papers, double-blind review, conference schedule, assignment of reviewers, and management of Q&A.

4. Agile Backlog Creation

The functional requirements were converted into user stories and grouped under suitable epics. Each story was given a priority and a Fibonacci story point value based on its relative effort.

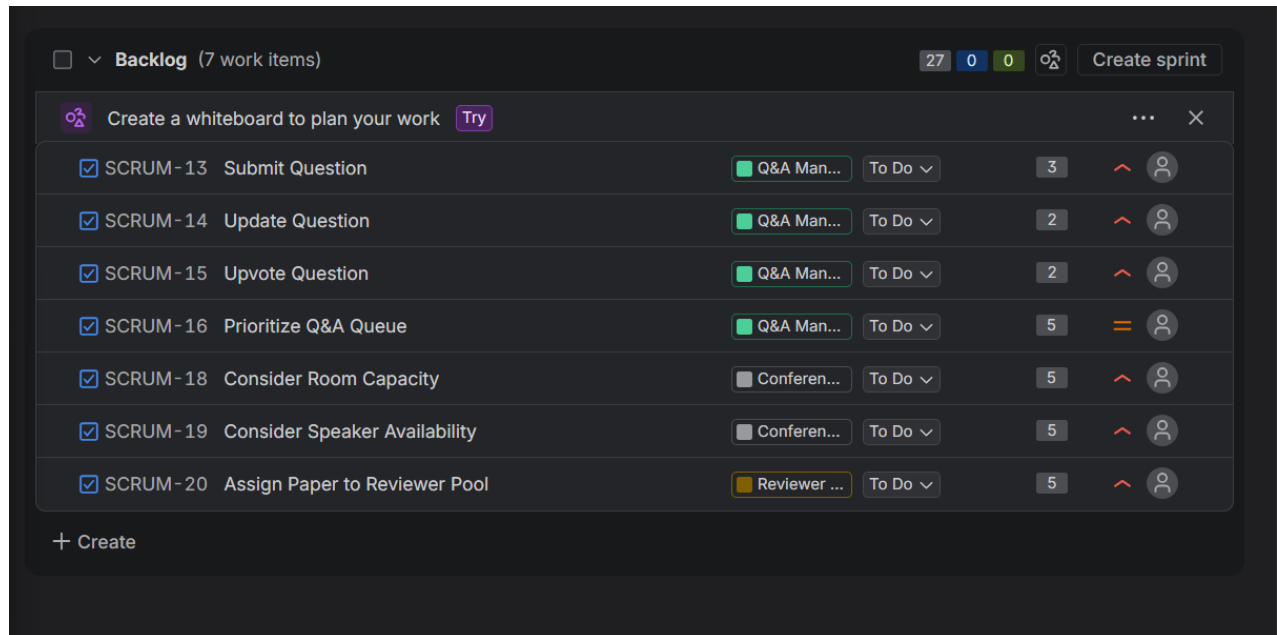


Figure 1: Jira backlog with user stories and story points.

Backlog Summary

- Paper Submission & Double Blind Reviewing – Paper Submission, Validation of Paper Submission, Paper Anonymization.
- Conference Scheduling – Multi Track Scheduling, Room Capacity, Speaker Availability.
- Reviewer Allocation – Paper Assigned to Pool of Reviewers.
- Q&A Management – Question Submission, Question Update, Question Up-vote.

5. Sprint 1

Sprint 1 was planned for one week. Its goal was to complete the core paper submission and conference scheduling functionality. Four stories were selected with a total of 21 story points.

Sprint 1 stories:

- Submit Paper – 5 points
- Validate Paper Submission – 3 points
- Anonymize Submitted Paper – 5 points
- Generate Multi-Track Schedule – 8 points

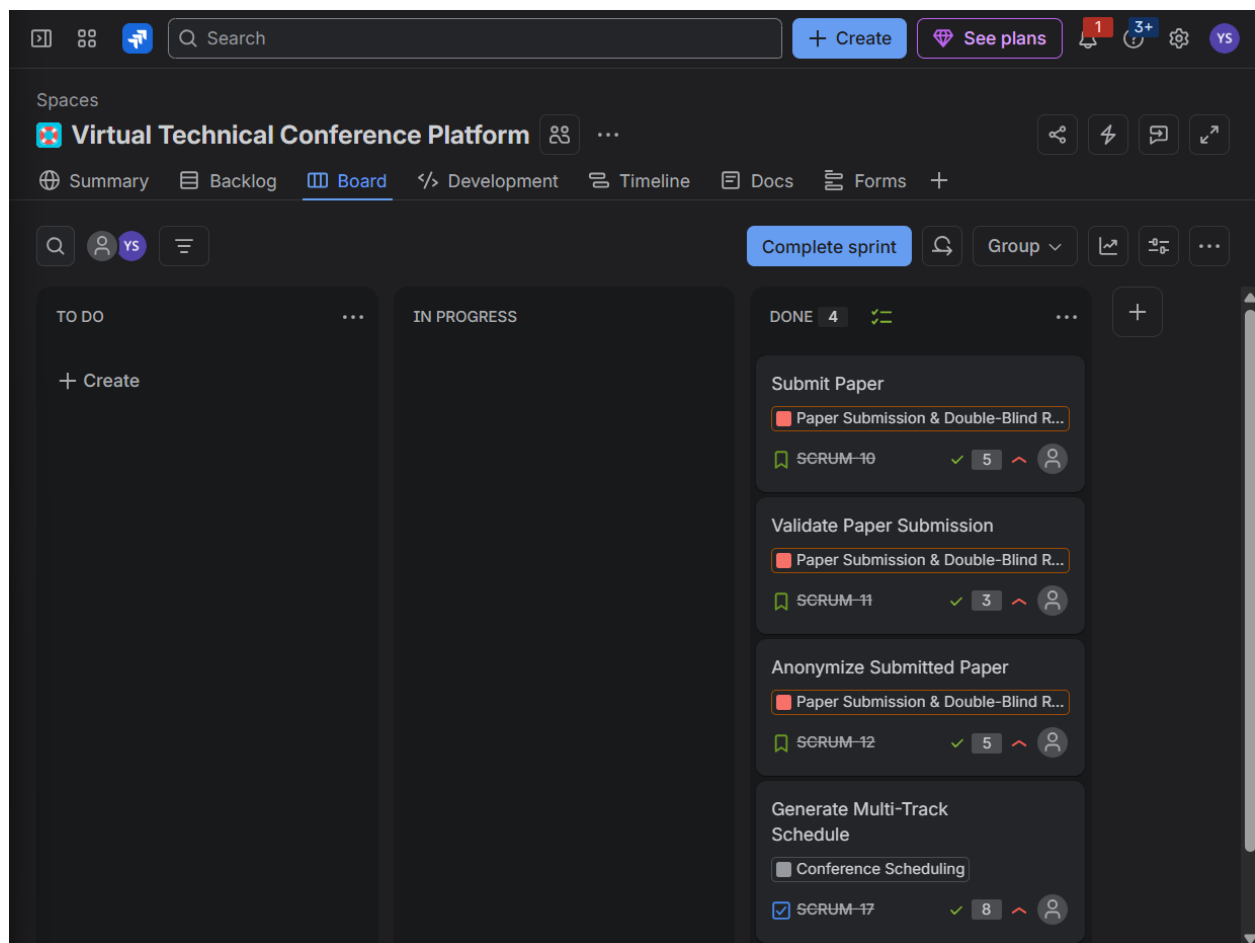
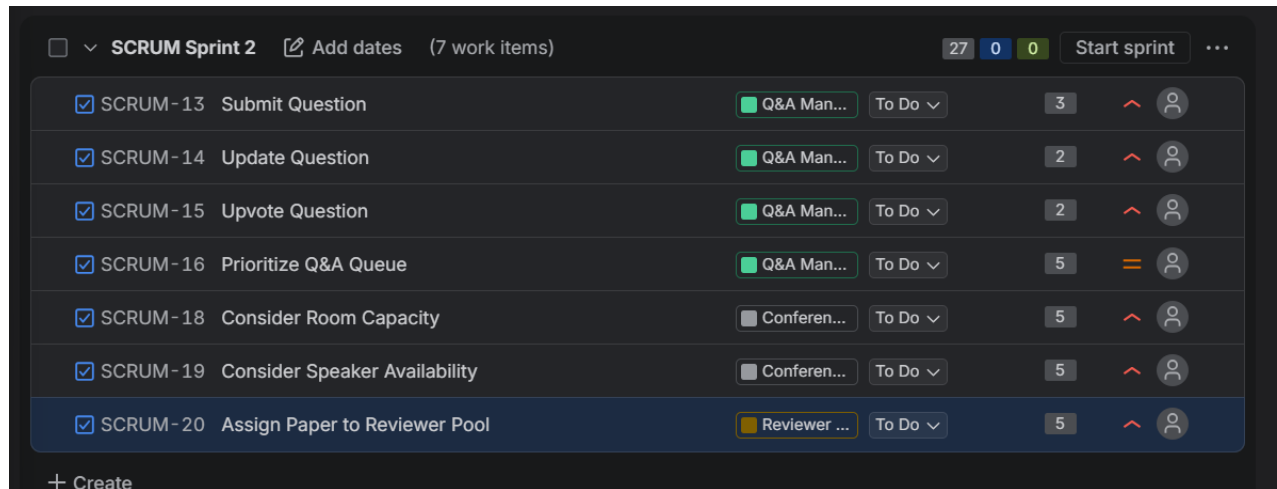


Figure 2: Sprint 1 active sprint board after completing the planned work.

All four Sprint 1 stories were moved to Done during the simulation.

6. Sprint 2 Planning

The remaining seven stories were placed into Sprint 2. The sprint focused on Q&A management, scheduling constraints, and reviewer assignment. The planned work was 27 story points.



The screenshot shows a Jira board for 'SCRUM Sprint 2'. At the top, it indicates 'Add dates' and '(7 work items)'. On the right, there are counters for '27' (total points), '0' (points completed), and '0' (points in progress), along with a 'Start sprint' button and a menu icon. The board lists seven items, each with a checkbox, ID, title, assignee, status, points, and action icons. The last item, 'SCRUM-20 Assign Paper to Reviewer Pool', is highlighted in blue.

ID	Title	Assignee	Status	Points	Action
SCRUM-13	Submit Question	Q&A Man...	To Do	3	Up/Down arrows, User icon
SCRUM-14	Update Question	Q&A Man...	To Do	2	Up/Down arrows, User icon
SCRUM-15	Upvote Question	Q&A Man...	To Do	2	Up/Down arrows, User icon
SCRUM-16	Prioritize Q&A Queue	Q&A Man...	To Do	5	Up/Down arrows, User icon
SCRUM-18	Consider Room Capacity	Conferen...	To Do	5	Up/Down arrows, User icon
SCRUM-19	Consider Speaker Availability	Conferen...	To Do	5	Up/Down arrows, User icon
SCRUM-20	Assign Paper to Reviewer Pool	Reviewer ...	To Do	5	Up/Down arrows, User icon

+ Create

Figure 3: Sprint 2 planned work items.

Sprint 2 stories:

- Submit Question – 3 points
- Update Question – 2 points
- Upvote Question – 2 points
- Prioritize Q&A Queue – 5 points
- Consider Room Capacity – 5 points
- Consider Speaker Availability – 5 points
- Assign Paper to Reviewer Pool – 5 points

7.1 Sprint 2 Simulation – Progress

The sprint was simulated by moving the selected stories from To Do to In Progress and then to Done. This screenshot shows the progress at this stage of the simulation.

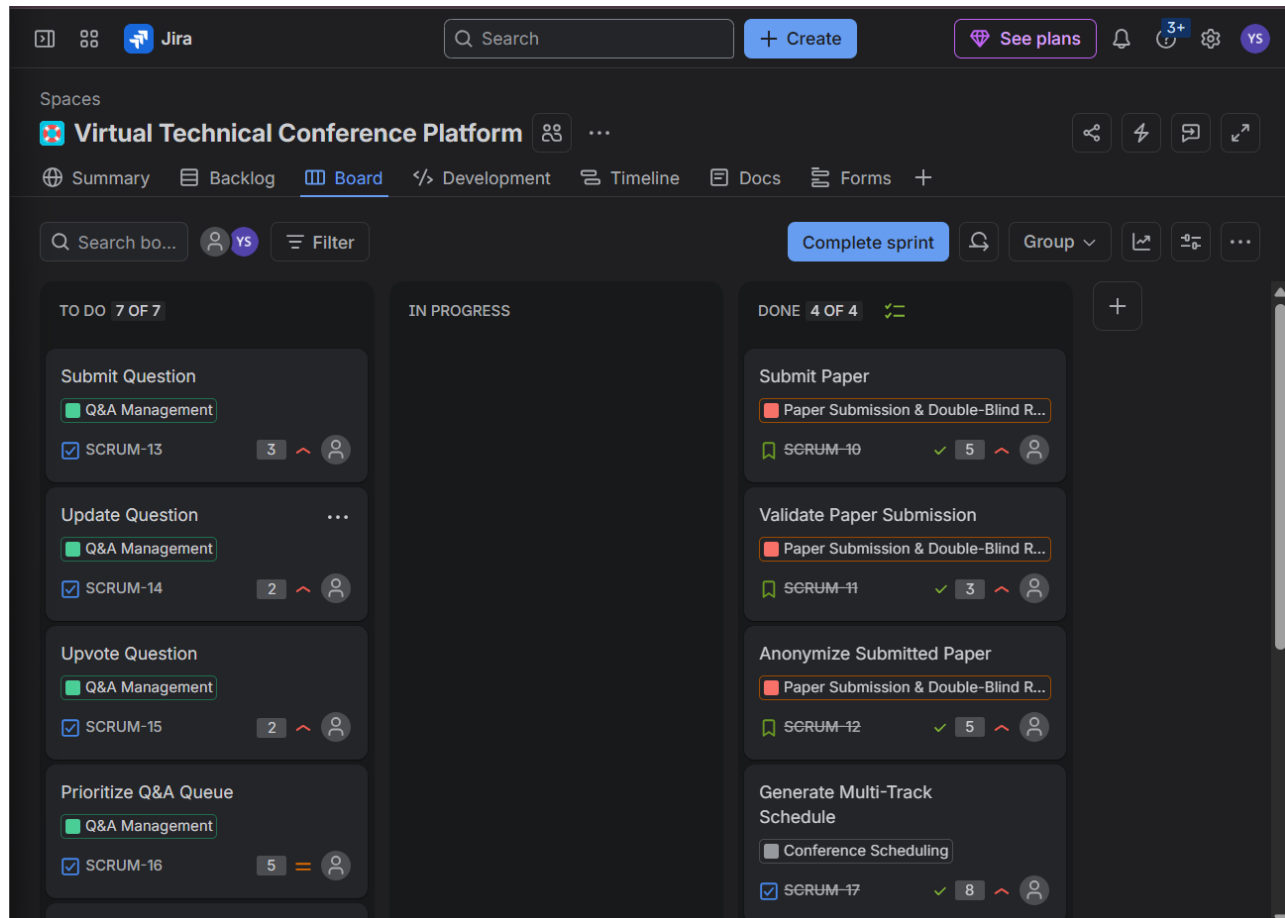


Figure 4: Sprint 2 with stories moved into In Progress.

7.2 Sprint 2 Simulation – Progress

The sprint was simulated by moving the selected stories from To Do to In Progress and then to Done. This screenshot shows the progress at this stage of the simulation.

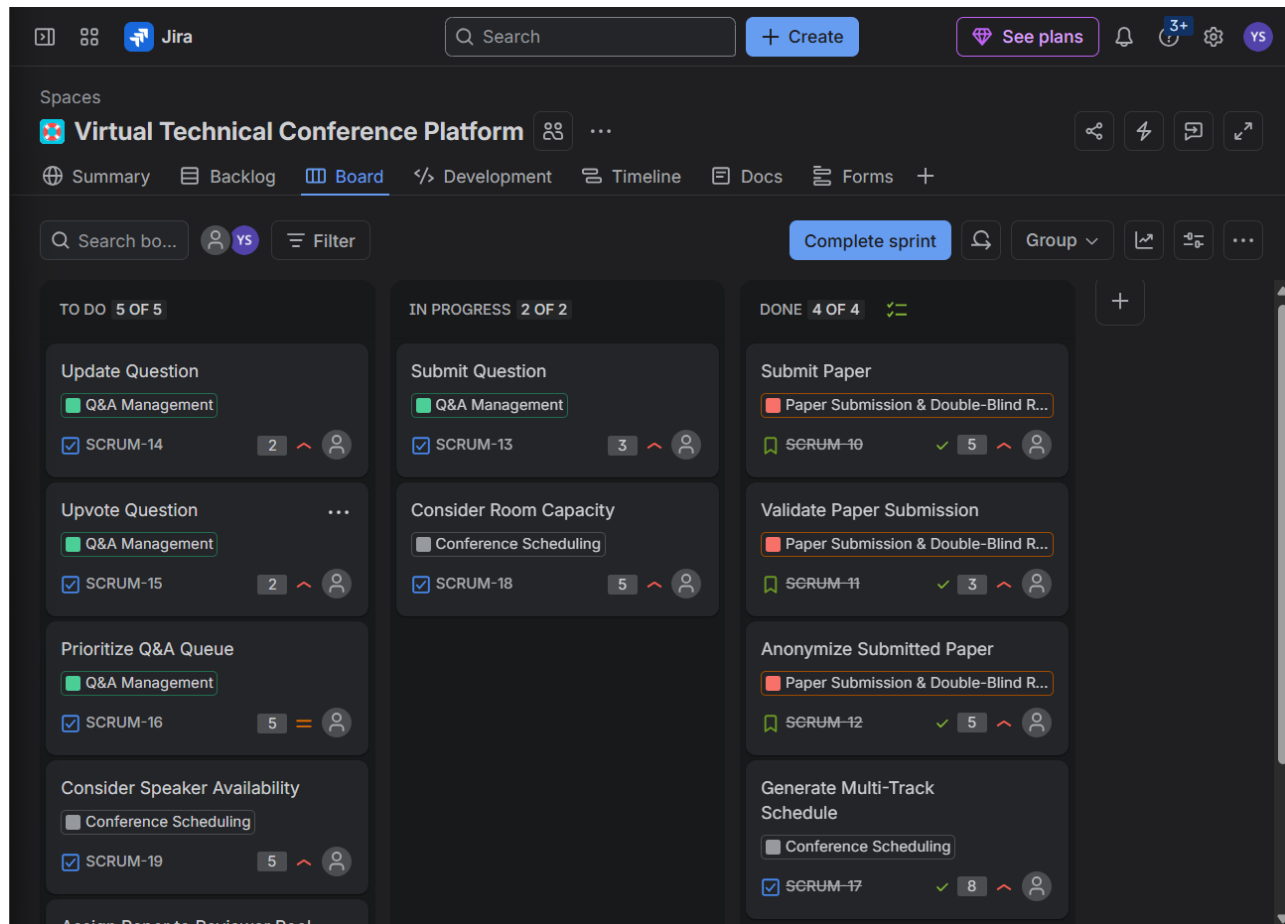


Figure 5: Sprint 2 after completing the first set of stories.

7.3 Sprint 2 Simulation – Progress

The sprint was simulated by moving the selected stories from To Do to In Progress and then to Done. This screenshot shows the progress at this stage of the simulation.

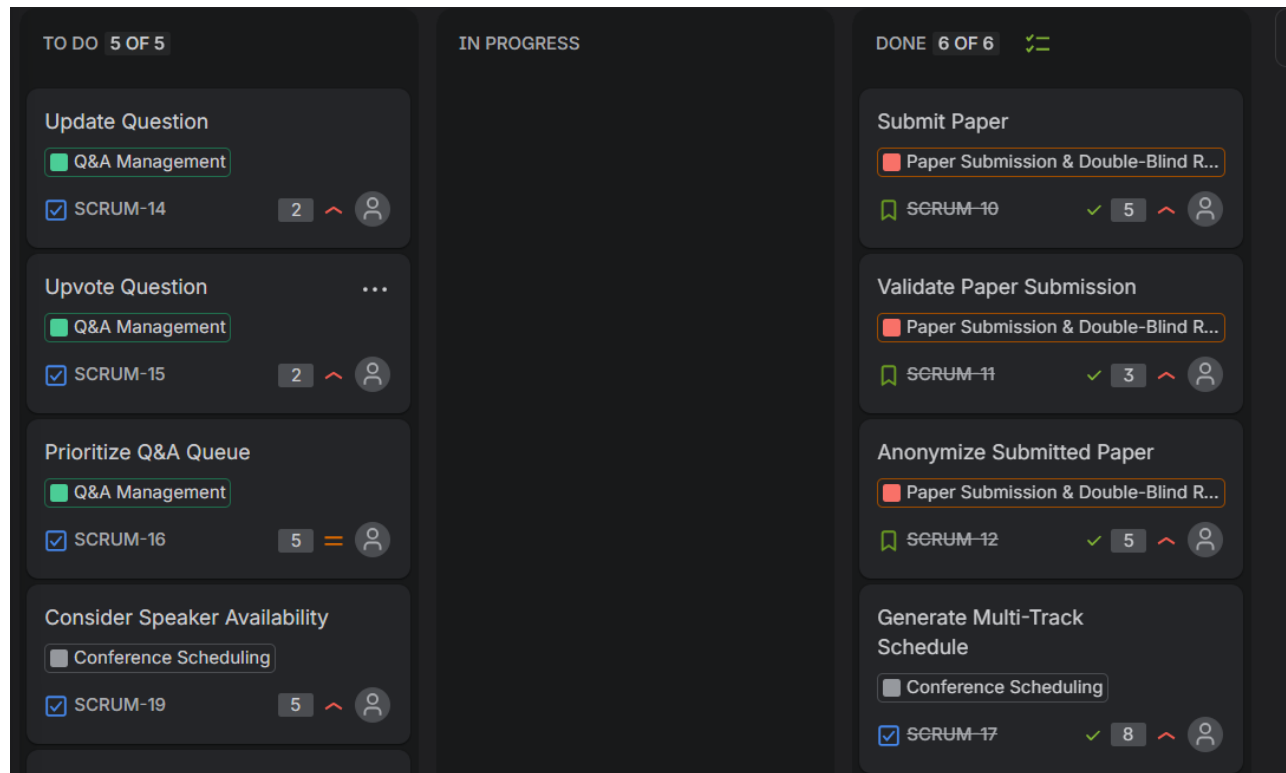


Figure 6: Sprint 2 with the next stories in progress.

7.4 Sprint 2 Simulation – Progress

The sprint was simulated by moving the selected stories from To Do to In Progress and then to Done. This screenshot shows the progress at this stage of the simulation.

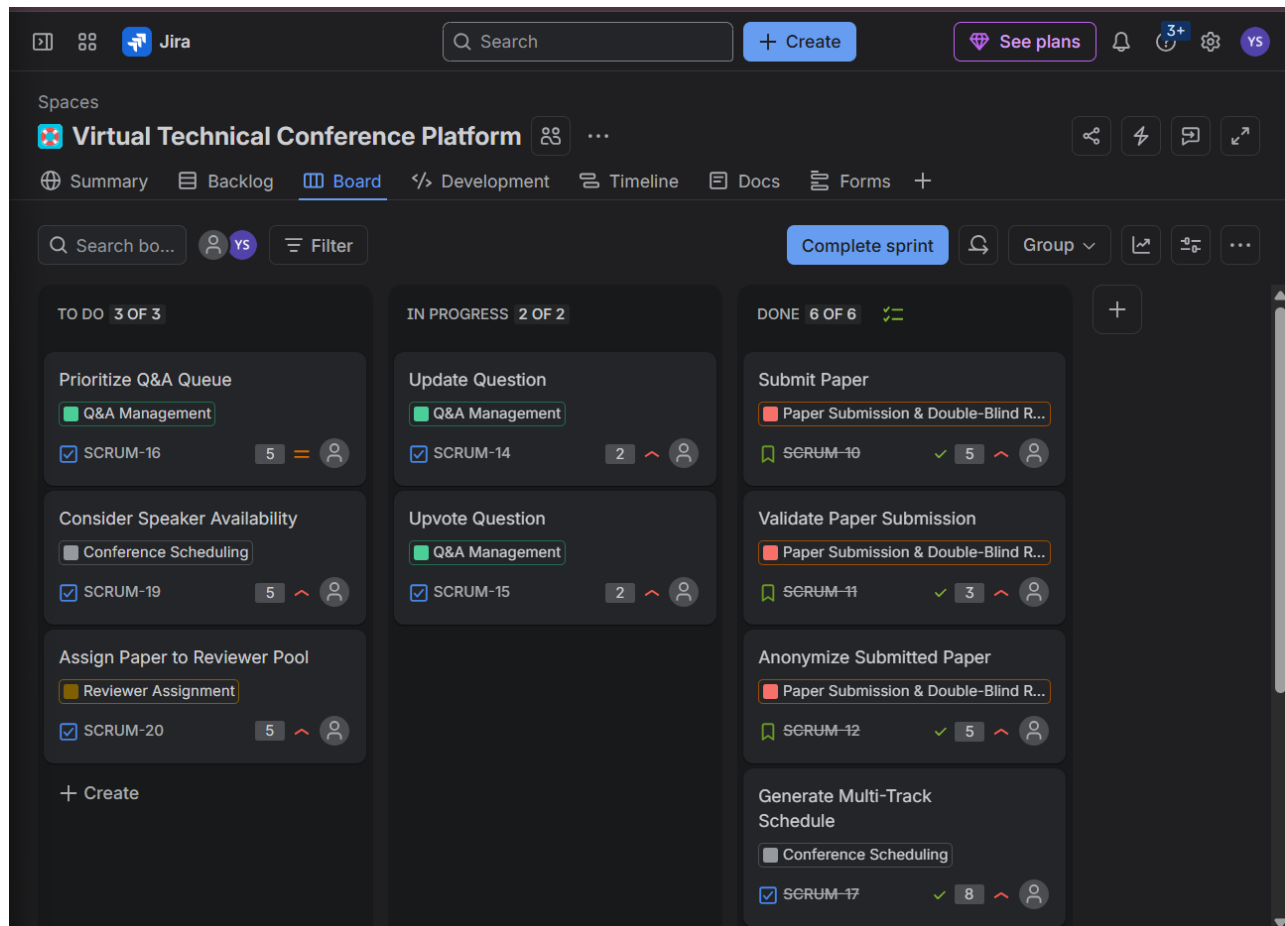


Figure 7: Sprint 2 with the final stories in progress.

8. Burndown Charts

After the sprint work was completed, the Jira Sprint Burndown Chart was checked. The chart compares the remaining work with the ideal burn rate.

8.1 Sprint 1 Burndown

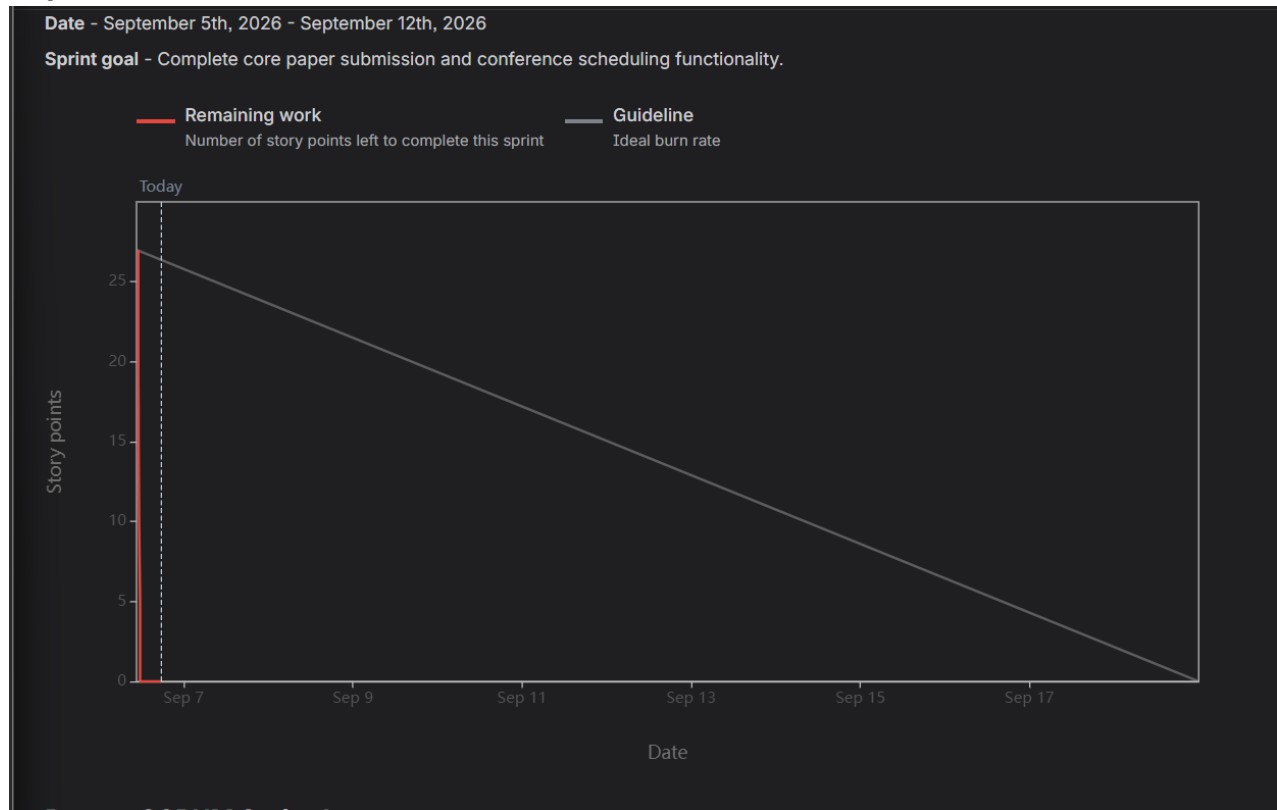


Figure 8: Sprint 1 burndown chart.

8.2 Sprint 2 Burndown

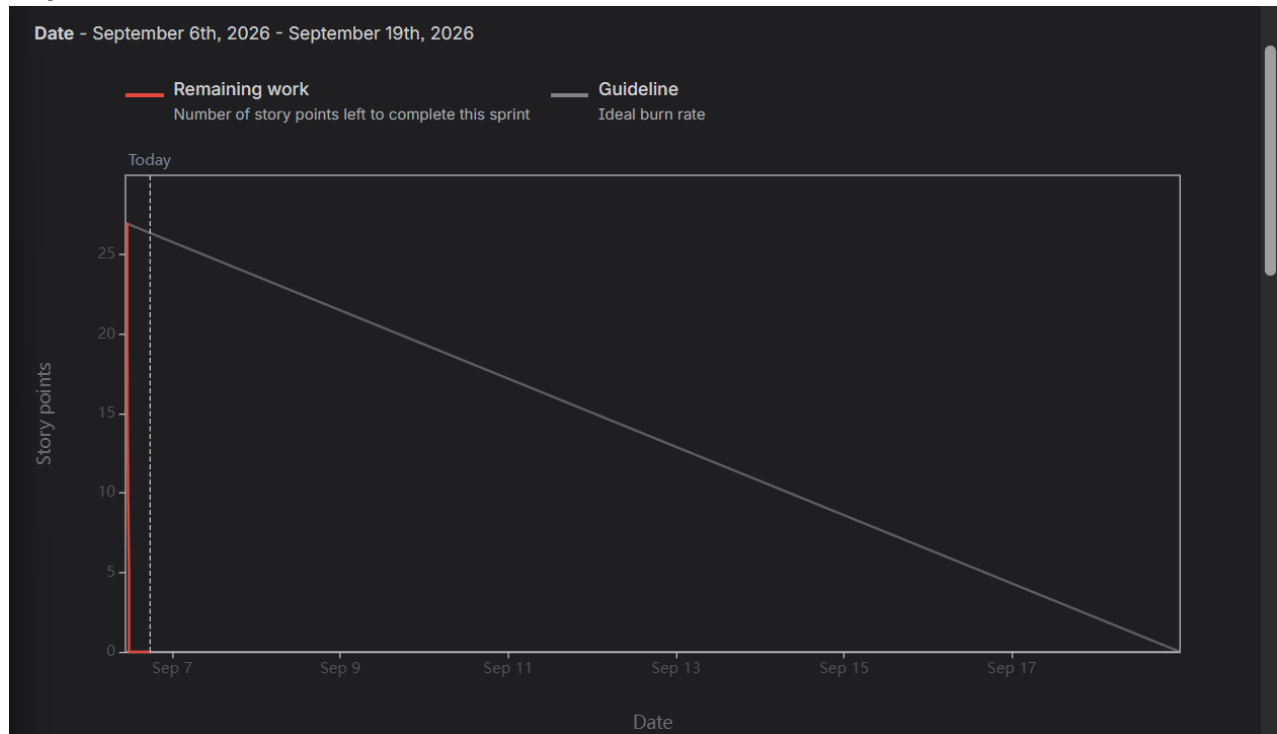


Figure 9: Sprint 2 burndown chart.

9. Reflection

1. Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Yes. The story points were appropriate for the work done. Small stories such as Update Question and Upvote Question received few points compared to the complex task of scheduling that received many points. All planned stories were done; hence, the estimation was appropriate.

2. Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Yes, indeed. Important elements like submission of papers, verification, anonymity, scheduling, question-answer sessions, and allocation of reviewers were accorded priority so as to develop the core elements of the system first.

3. How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

Sprint execution was as per the planned approach. Sprint 1 involved submission of papers and scheduling of conferences while sprint 2 involved Q&A, scheduling constraints and reviewer allocation. The stories went from To Do to In Progress and finally to Done.

4. What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

The burndown chart indicated that all the activities have been accomplished within the schedule. The story points left went to zero rapidly since it was just a simulation. This implies that the workload was easy for the group.

10. Conclusion

This lab helped us practically learn Agile project management by using Jira. First, we created the backlog based on the requirement, estimated work in story points, conducted two sprints, and finally used burndown charts for tracking the progress.